

Tania Ortiz

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EDUCATION

The University of Texas at San Antonio — M.S.I.T, Cybersecurity	May 2028
The University of Texas at San Antonio — B.B.A., Cybersecurity (Secure Software Analyst), GPA: 3.46	Dec 2026
Laredo College — A.A.S., Cyber Defense, Honors	May 2023

TECHNICAL SKILLS AND CERTIFICATIONS

AWS, Azure, Linux, Docker, EJBCA, Kubernetes, Terraform, CI/CD, Python, PowerShell, Java, JavaScript, REST APIs, Git, SIEM, Prometheus, Grafana, KQL, Nessus, OpenSSL, ServiceNow, Splunk, SQL, CompTIA CySA+, CompTIA Security+, Anthropic
(Introduction to Claude Cowork, AI Fluency, Claude 101)

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

Texas Department of Transportation – <i>Cybersecurity Analyst Intern</i> , Remote, TX	Sept 2026 – Present
Supported enterprise cybersecurity operations by monitoring security events, conducting vulnerability assessments and incident investigations, and documenting findings using SIEM, KQL, and security monitoring tools.	
PayPal – <i>Cybersecurity Engineer Intern</i> , Austin, TX	Jun 2026 – Sept 2026
- Designed and executed 60+ compatibility and performance evaluations of NIST post-quantum certificates (ML-DSA-65/87, FIPS 204) vs. RSA-2048/4096 across TLS 1.3, mTLS, and hybrid dual-cert server configurations to evaluate enterprise PQC migration feasibility. - Root-caused an ASN.1 encoding defect preventing OpenSSL from parsing ML-DSA private keys; corrected byte-level formatting and validated against live TLS 1.3 handshakes to unblock testing pipelines. - Architected and executed automated benchmarking pipelines across 1,000+ trials, quantifying TLS and mTLS handshake latency trade-offs and identifying critical throughput advantages of ML-DSA over legacy high-bit RSA algorithms to guide production migration strategy.	
CPS Energy – <i>IT Technician Intern</i> , San Antonio, TX	Jan 2026 – May 2026
- Deployed and set up 300+ enterprise computers using USB boot configurations, including 30+ workstation and docking station setups with required software. - Provided Tier 1/2 technical support to 600+ employees, helping resolve network, Active Directory (AD), and MFA issues through ServiceNow.	
H-E-B, Inc. – <i>Network Engineering Intern</i> , San Antonio, TX	May 2025 – Aug 2025
- Engineered a custom Python API metrics exporter to capture real-time telemetry from 4 network services and 7 hardware appliances. - Managed containerized monitoring services across 3 Kubernetes clusters, setting up health checks and Grafana dashboards to track network and system performance. - Automated CI/CD pipelines with linting and testing, eliminating deployment overhead across 13+ production systems.	
IBC Bank – <i>AML Analyst</i> , Laredo, TX	Mar 2024 – Aug 2024
- Reviewed 40+ transaction monitoring alerts per day in FCRM, comparing customer activity against KYC profiles and maintaining an 85% closure rate. - Investigated approximately 10 high-risk cases per week, focusing on activity such as structuring, dormant account reactivations, and high-value cross-border wires. - Documented investigation findings and prepared detailed case narratives for SAR review, following BSA/AML and FinCEN requirements and escalating suspicious activity when appropriate.	

PROJECTS

AI-Powered Phishing Detector <i>Python, Plotly Dash, AWS (IAM, VPC, S3, RDS), Cursor AI, Google Colab, Terraform</i>	
- Architected a security platform combining TF-IDF heuristics and a fine-tuned DistilBERT transformer across 111,754 URLs and 17,537 emails, achieving 99.98% URL accuracy and 97.21% email accuracy with 0% false positives on transformer evaluations. - Deployed a FastAPI backend and Plotly Dash frontend on AWS via Terraform.	
System Information Exporter <i>Grafana, Prometheus, Python</i>	
- Architected a monitoring system using FastAPI to collect host CPU, memory, process, and GPU metrics. - Integrated Prometheus for scraping, an Isolation Forest model for real-time anomaly detection, and Grafana dashboards for live system observability.	
Centralized Logging & Monitoring System <i>Apache Kafka, ELK Stack, Docker</i>	
Implemented a real-time log ingestion pipeline with structured parsing and interactive dashboards.	
Automated Cloud Compliance Auditor <i>AWS Config, Security Hub, S3, SNS, IAM, Lambda, CloudTrail</i>	
Developed a DevSecOps platform auditing cloud infrastructure against CIS, HIPAA, and PCI-DSS with automated alerts and remediation.	
SOC HomeLab <i>Microsoft Sentinel, Azure Monitor Agent, KQL</i>	
- Integrated VM logs into Microsoft Sentinel via Azure Monitor Agent (AMA) for centralized real-time security monitoring. - Created and tested Kusto Query Language (KQL) rules to detect unauthorized RDP sign-in attempts and trigger security alerts.	
CloudHUB <i>Nextcloud, AWS EC2, Docker, Tailscale VPN</i>	
Self-hosted productivity workspace on AWS EC2, secured with Tailscale VPN and deployed via Docker.	